Printing the support desk

Eight pages in all, one copy of each section. For about 25 people in up to 6 groups, print these counts.

ITEM	PAGES	COPIES	SHEETS
Team packet · Follow a flowchart	1	3	3
Team packet · Follow a prompt	1	2	2
Ticket deck (both teams), one per group	3	5	15
Facilitator key · debrief	1	1	1
Facilitator · tally sheet	1	1	1
Total			**22**

- Each group needs one team packet and one ticket deck. Give the flowchart packets to three groups and the prompt packets to two.
- Print on US Letter, black and white, single-sided, at 100% scale. Turn off “fit to page” and headers and footers.
- Keep the facilitator key and tally sheet with you. Don’t hand them out.

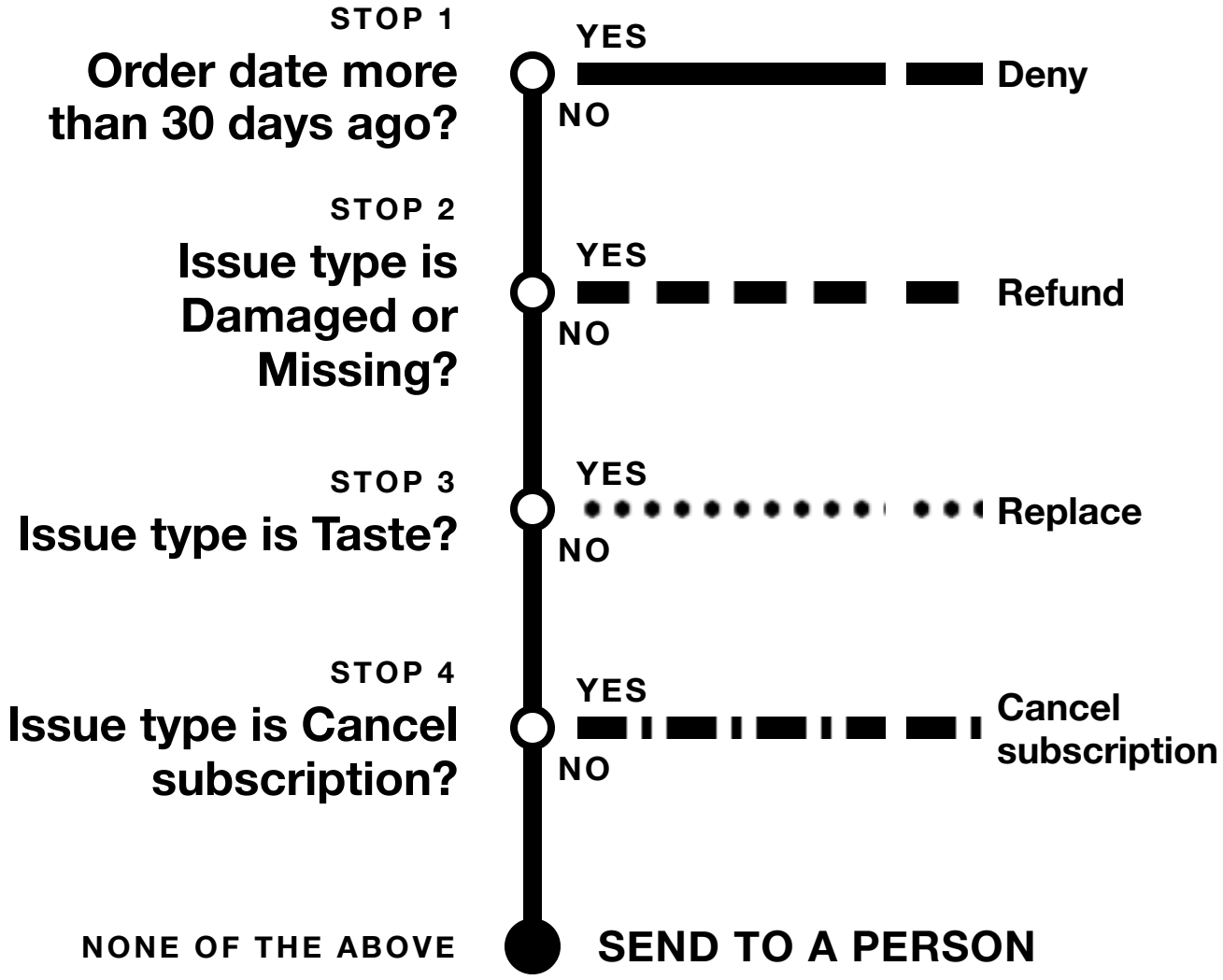
✂ **Cut the ticket cards out along the dashed lines before the game starts.**

The flowchart

Follow it exactly, even when it feels wrong.

Work in small groups. Designate one person to have your flowchart or prompt ready to go.

Everyone else works through the customer messages and decides what to do.



The flowchart only sees the form fields.

Line keys: solid = Deny · long dashes = Refund · dots = Replace · dash and dot = Cancel subscription · filled circle = Send to a person.

The prompt

Use your judgment within it.

Work in small groups. Designate one person to have your flowchart or prompt ready to go.

Everyone else works through the customer messages and decides what to do.

THE PROMPT

You answer customers for Brew Diligence, a coffee roaster.

Keep good customers happy and be fair to the business.

Refunds under $30 are fine if the story is believable.

Send anything about safety, legal threats, or a long-time customer who is upset to a person.

Don’t refund the same customer twice in 90 days.

Brew Diligence support tickets

Cut along the dashed lines. Tick one action per ticket.

✂ Ticket 1

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 3 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Damaged

ORDER VALUE $18

"My bag arrived split open, beans everywhere."

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

✂ Ticket 2

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 10 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Cancel subscription

"Please cancel my subscription, moving abroad."

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

✂ Ticket 3

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 5 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Taste

"Tastes burnt. Not what I expected from you."

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

✂ Ticket 4

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 34 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Taste

"Ordered 34 days ago, only just opened it, it's stale. I've subscribed for three years."

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

Brew Diligence support tickets

Cut along the dashed lines. Tick one action per ticket.

✂ Ticket 5

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 6 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Damaged

ORDER VALUE $26

"Bag was damaged AND I want to cancel."

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

✂ Ticket 6

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 4 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Damaged

"Found a small piece of glass in the bag."

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

✂ Ticket 7

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 8 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Missing

REFUND HISTORY refunded twice this quarter

"Missing again. Third time this quarter, refund please."

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

✂ Ticket 8

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 12 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Other

ORDER VALUE $24

"Was a gift, my friend hated it. Can I get my money back?"

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

Brew Diligence support tickets

Cut along the dashed lines. Tick one action per ticket.

✂ Ticket 9

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 9 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Other

"If this isn't fixed I'm contacting my lawyer."

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

✂ Ticket 10

WEB FORM

ORDER DATE 2 days ago

ISSUE TYPE Other

"Love the beans! Can you do a decaf version?"

ACTION (TICK ONE)

- ☐ Refund
- ☐ Replace
- ☐ Deny
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Send to a person

The ten tickets: what a careful person does

Flowchart and prompt columns show what each rule set did, and whether it matched.

TICKET · CAREFUL ANSWER	FLOWCHART	PROMPT
1 · Bag arrived split open Careful: Refund	✓ Refund (Damaged)	✓ Refund
2 · Cancel, moving abroad Careful: Cancel	✓ Cancel (Cancel subscription)	✓ Cancel
3 · Tastes burnt Careful: Replace	✓ Replace (Taste)	✓ Replace
4 · Ordered 34 days ago Careful: Send to a person	✗ Deny (34 days, over 30): denies a three-year subscriber	✓ Send to a person, or refund
5 · Damaged bag and cancel Careful: Refund and cancel	✗ Refund (Damaged); cancel missed	✗ Refund; cancel missed
6 · Glass in the bag Careful: Send to a person	[✗] Refund (Damaged): a safety issue, refunded and moved on	✓ Send to a person
7 · Missing again, third time Careful: Deny the repeat refund	[✗] Refund (Missing): repeat refunds go through, a fraud risk	✓ Deny the repeat refund
8 · Gift, friend hated it Careful: Refund	✗ Send to a person (Other)	✓ Refund, if under $30
9 · Lawyer threat Careful: Send to a person	✓ Send to a person (Other)	✓ Send to a person
10 · Decaf request Careful: Answer; no action	✗ Send to a person (Other)	✗ No action fits (gap)
Totals	**4 ✓ · 4 ✗ · 2 costly**	**8 ✓ · 2 ✗ · 0 costly**

✓ matches a careful person · ✗ wrong, recoverable · [✗] costly enough to question the process

Which failures came from missing information, missing rules, or a need for judgment?

We changed the information and the policy as well as the approach, so these scores describe this exercise, not models in general.

What each group decided

Write the action each group chose for each ticket: Refund, Replace, Deny, Cancel, or Person.

TICKET	GROUP 1	GROUP 2	GROUP 3	GROUP 4	GROUP 5	GROUP 6
Team (tick)	☐F ☐P	☐F ☐P	☐F ☐P	☐F ☐P	☐F ☐P	☐F ☐P
1 · Bag split open						
2 · Cancel, moving abroad						
3 · Tastes burnt						
4 · Ordered 34 days ago						
5 · Damaged and cancel						
6 · Glass in the bag						
7 · Missing, third time						
8 · Gift, friend hated it						
9 · Lawyer threat						
10 · Decaf request						

Notes: where the room split, and what surprised people